

‘They have no problem ... taking responsibility for what they have done in this lifetime. It is much harder for us to do that.’

— JENNIFER ROSE, a medium and spiritual healer, speaking of the dead



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

FOR ALMOST 20 years, the Life After Life Club at Laguna Woods Village has tried to interact with the spirit world.

COLUMN ONE

Really hoping the spirits move them

At an O.C. retirement community, the Life After Life Club enlists a psychic to share with it what might lie in the world beyond

By Thomas Curwen

With shoulder-length blond hair, black dress and black knee-high boots, Jennifer Rose cuts a preacherly silhouette — less Bible-thumping, more New Age — standing on a small stage in the retirement community of Laguna Woods Village.

“There’s a lot of spirit here already,” she says. Her audience grows quiet. “So I hope you’re starting to feel that too. As

the atmosphere changes, it gets a little buzzy.”

When Rose speaks of spirit, she is not talking about something metaphoric or symbolic; there’s nothing gauzy in this invocation. When Rose speaks of spirit, she is speaking of the dead, though she would never use that word. Dead is lifeless and gone, but spirit, which she courts, is animated, full of love and loved. The room holds on to her words with reverence.

“Connecting with your loved ones is a passion of mine,” she says. “I get to make friends every time I do it — over there and over here.”

A few late arrivals find the last remaining seats in the clubhouse. Nearly 80 in total, they have come here on a gray Saturday morning for a reading, as has been practiced in America going back to at least 1849 when the Fox sisters, Kate and Maggie, packed a hall in Rochester.

[See [Psychic](#), A12]

Recent gains uplift state GOP

Republicans celebrate at convention, dissect how they and Trump won more votes in California last year.

By SEEMA MEHTA

SACRAMENTO — A caravan of pickup trucks waving large President Trump flags circled the California Republican Party’s convention this weekend, with drivers occasionally hopping out to dance to the Village People song “Y.M.C.A.,” a favorite tune at the president’s rallies.

Inside, delegates posed with giant cutouts of Trump, wore glittery gold-sequined jackets emblazoned with “Trump the Golden Era” and snapped up “MAGA” rhinestone jewelry.

Once dominated by Reagan-era Republicans who favored traditional conservative policies including opposing the Russia-led Soviet Union and favoring free trade, the California GOP is being reshaped by Trump’s populism.

“Just like Reagan was transformational figure in the political world, Donald Trump is a transformational figure,” former state GOP chairman Jim Brulte said.

For a party that has long been largely irrelevant in California politics — having last elected a statewide candidate nearly two decades ago — there were some bright spots in the November election. Republicans increased their representation in both houses of the state Legislature, the first time the GOP has done so in a presidential election year since 1980.

Though Trump lost the state by 20 percentage points to former Vice President Kamala Harris, the Democratic presidential nominee and Californian, the Republican received more votes in November here than he did in the last two presidential elections.

Trump also did better with Latinos across the nation, winning 43% of their votes, according to the Associated Press. In California, Republicans increased their support from this voting bloc as well, according to the nonpartisan Cook Political Report as well as GOP officials.

“Here’s the secret sauce. You ready for it?” Rep. Tony Gonzalez (R-Texas) told California Republicans at the party’s Saturday luncheon. “You have to show up. Step one, show up. Show up early. Show up often. Don’t speak a little bit of broken Spanish. Don’t throw up an

[See [GOP](#), A6]

Mexico’s leader faces Trump test

Though she’s kept up a delicate balancing act so far, Claudia Sheinbaum has won no U.S. guarantees.

By PATRICK J. McDONNELL AND KATE LINTHICUM

MEXICO CITY — The president stood amid the admiring throngs and declared victory.

“We have gathered here to congratulate ourselves

because — in relations with the United States, with its government — dialogue and respect have prevailed,” President Claudia Sheinbaum told the adoring multitudes gathered in the capital’s historic central plaza, or Zócalo, in a mega-event organized by her ruling party.

Sheinbaum’s triumphalist exhortations on March 9 dramatized how she has, to date, successfully walked an extremely precarious tight rope: Appeasing President Trump and postponing enactment of most of his

[See [Sheinbaum](#), A4]



EDUARDO VERDUGO Associated Press

PRESIDENT Claudia Sheinbaum beams before supporters at a Mexico City rally she convened March 9 to welcome President Trump’s decision to postpone tariffs.

U.S. deports migrants despite order

Federal judge’s ruling was issued as hundreds were en route to El Salvador and Honduras. [NATION](#), A5

Sweeping DEI under the rug

Since Trump retook office, Hollywood has scaled back the initiatives. [BUSINESS](#), A9

Weather

Stray p.m. shower. L.A. Basin: 61/45. [B6](#)

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Hazardous waste rollback sought

State regulators may let some landfills take more contaminated soil. [CALIFORNIA](#), B1

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California Office for Civil Rights closing

About 1,500 cases are pending at shuttered agency, which shields students against bias.

By JAWEED KALEEM AND HOWARD BLUME

When the Trump administration announced last week that about half the staff of the U.S. Department

of Education were to be laid off, the slashing closed down the San Francisco regional branch of the Office for Civil Rights, responsible for providing the state’s students protection from discrimination.

The California office handled a bulging caseload of students, families and school staff: alleged unequal academic instruction for disabled students; allegations of campus sexual assault; claims of unfair discipline meted out to students of color; alleged bullying of LGBTQ+ students.

The cases include those alleging reverse discrimination, such as unfair or illegal advantages provided to racial or ethnic minorities.

About 1,500 California cases are pending, according to multiple laid-off attorneys for the Bay Area office, who said they have been largely locked out of case

files and email. They can receive messages on cases but were unable to reply after receiving layoff notices, despite being technically employed until March 21.

The pending cases include open investigations, those that are in mediation, resolved cases under monitoring to ensure agreements are kept, and complaints being researched by civil rights attorneys, which had yet to

[See [Closure](#), A8]



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